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NOVEMBER 2025

**U/106/24AT00201/
2435205**

Paper II — ENGLISH

Time : Three hours

Maximum : 100 marks

SECTION A — ($10 \times 2 = 20$ marks)

Answer ALL the questions.

1. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.
 - (a) I going to get up early tomorrow.
 - (b) We go to Spain sometime soon.
2. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.
 - (a) Could you telling me the time?
 - (b) It took a long time, but I manages to repair the car.
3. Correct the errors and rewrite the sentences.
 - (a) I want get a new bike.
 - (b) I'll never forget to meeting you.

4. Complete the sentence using, any, somebody, anybody, something or anything.
- (a) I haven't got _____ to wear.
- (b) There's _____ waiting to see you.
5. Put in the right kind of infinitive :
- (a) I ought _____ right now. (work)
- (b) Try _____ back late. (not be)
6. Complete the following sentences with the correct tense of the verbs given in brackets.
- (a) I really _____ go now.
(shall, would, must)
- (b) _____ I carry your bag?
(might, will, shall)
7. Give the synonyms of :
- (a) sturdy
- (b) mortality
8. Give one-word substitute :
- (a) a person who has been forced to leave their country in order to escape war, persecution, or natural disaster.
- (b) disagreement or fight, especially with someone in an official position.

9. Use the word *tour* in a meaningful sentence.

10. Match the following words with their meanings :

S.No.	Words		Meanings
(a)	Literacy	(i)	The subjects and materials that are taught in schools.
(b)	Curriculum	(ii)	The art or science of teaching.
(c)	Pedagogy	(iii)	Copying someone else's work and presenting it as your own.
(d)	Plagiarism	(iv)	An official record of a student's academic performance.
		(v)	Ability to read and write

SECTION B — ($5 \times 7 = 35$ marks)

Answer ALL the questions in about 150 words.

11. Read the following passage and answer the questions given.

The African elephant (*Loxodonta africana*) is the largest land mammal on Earth. These majestic creatures are found in diverse habitats across sub-Saharan Africa, including savannas, forests, and deserts. Elephants are known for their remarkable intelligence, strong social bonds, and complex communication methods. They live in matriarchal herds, led by the oldest female, and exhibit behaviours such as cooperation, empathy and mourning.

African elephants are herbivores, consuming a variety of vegetation, including grasses, fruits, and bark. Their large size and feeding habits significantly impact their environment; they help maintain the ecological balance by dispersing seeds and creating clearings in forests, which benefits other species.

Despite their ecological importance, African elephants face numerous threats. Poaching for ivory, habitat destruction due to agriculture and urban expansion and human-wildlife conflict have led to a decline in their populations. Conservation efforts are underway to protect these magnificent animals, including anti-poaching laws, habitat restoration projects and community-based conservation initiatives.

- (a) How do African elephants help maintain their environment?
- (b) Where are African elephants primarily found?
- (c) What does the term 'matriarchal' mean in relation to elephant herds?
- (d) What do African elephants eat?
- (e) Why are African elephants considered intelligent and social animals?
- (f) What are the main threats facing African elephants?
- (g) African elephants live in herds led by _____
 - (i) the oldest male
 - (ii) the youngest female
 - (iii) the oldest female
 - (iv) a male leader

12. Write a postcard to a friend sharing your experience of camping or staying in a forest or nature park.

13. (a) Explain the ways in which “*Unsung Pandemic Heroes*” highlights the interconnectedness of global communities in times of crisis.

Or

(b) Compare and contrast Billy Collins imagined experiences of travel with the comfort of staying at home in “*Consolation*”.

14. (a) Construct the circumstances that required a ‘concerted’ effort on the part of the Kerala government to combat Covid.

Or

(b) Justify the author A.R. Venkatachalapathy’s reference to Bharathi as ‘Tamil Tagore’.

15. (a) Narrate Taran N. Khan’s experiences visiting the houses of colleagues.

Or

(b) Evaluate Parle-G as an enduring brand in India.

SECTION C — ($3 \times 15 = 45$ marks)

Answer the following in about 250 words.

16. Read the following story and answer the questions.

The Story of an Hour

Knowing that Mrs. Mallard was afflicted with heart trouble, great care was taken to break to her as gently as possible the news of her husband's death.

It was her sister Josephine who told her, in broken sentences; veiled hints that revealed in half-concealing. Her husband's friend Richards was there, too, near her. It was he who had been in the newspaper office when intelligence of the railroad disaster was received, with Brently Mallard's name leading the list of "killed."

She did not hear the story as many women have heard the same, with a paralyzed inability to accept its significance. She wept at once, with sudden, wild abandonment, in her sister's arms. When the storm of grief had spent itself she went away to her room alone. She would have no one follow her.

There stood, facing the open window, a comfortable, roomy armchair. Into this she sank, pressed down by a physical exhaustion that haunted her body and seemed to reach into her soul.

She could see in the open square before her house the tops of trees that were all aquiver with the new spring life. There were patches of blue sky showing here and there through the clouds that had met and piled one above the other in the west facing her window.

She sat with her head thrown back upon the cushion of the chair, quite motionless, except when a sob came up into her throat and shook her, as a child who has cried itself to sleep continues to sob in its dreams.

She was young, with a fair, calm face, whose lines bespoke repression and even a certain strength. But now there was a dull stare in her eyes, whose gaze was fixed away off yonder on one of those patches of blue sky. It was not a glance of reflection, but rather indicated a suspension of intelligent thought.

There was something coming to her and she was waiting for it, fearfully. What was it? She did not know; it was too subtle and elusive to name. Now her bosom rose and fell tumultuously. She was beginning to recognize this thing that was approaching to possess her, and she was striving to beat it back with her will—as powerless as her two white slender hands would have been.

When she abandoned herself a little whispered word escaped her slightly parted lips. She said it over and over under her breath : “free, free, free!” The vacant stare and the look of terror that had followed it went from her eyes. They stayed keen and bright. Her pulses beat fast, and the coursing blood warmed and relaxed every inch of her body.

She did not stop to ask if it were or were not a monstrous joy that held her. A clear and exalted perception enabled her to dismiss the suggestion as trivial.

She knew that she would weep again when she saw the kind, tender hands folded in death; the face that had never looked save with love upon her, fixed and gray and dead. But she saw beyond that bitter moment a long procession of years to come that would belong to her absolutely. And she opened and spread her arms out to them in welcome.

There would be no one to live for during those coming years: she would live for herself. There would be no powerful will bending hers in that blind persistence with which men and women believe they have a right to impose a private will upon a fellow-creature. A kind intention or a cruel intention made the act seem no less a crime as she looked upon it in that brief moment of illumination.

And yet she had loved him—sometimes. Often she had not. What did it matter!

“Free! Body and soul free!” she kept whispering.

Josephine was kneeling before the closed door with her lips to the keyhole, imploring for admission. “Louise, open the door! I beg, open the door—you will make yourself ill. What are you doing, Louise? For heaven’s sake open the door.”

“Go away. I am not making myself ill.” No; she was drinking in a very elixir of life through that open window.

She arose at length and opened the door to her sister's importunities. There was a feverish triumph in her eyes, and she carried herself unwittingly like a goddess of Victory. She clasped her sister's waist, and together they descended the stairs. Richards stood waiting for them at the bottom.

Someone was opening the front door with a latchkey. It was Brently Mallard who entered, a little travel-stained, composedly carrying his grip-sack and umbrella. He had been far from the scene of the accident and did not even know there had been one. He stood amazed at Josephine's piercing cry; at Richards' quick motion to screen him from the view of his wife.

When the doctors came they said she had died of heart disease—of joy that kills.

Questions :

- (a) What is the gist of the story "The Story of an Hour"? (2)
- (b) What news did Mrs. Mallard receive, and how was it conveyed to her? (2)

- (c) State whether the following statements are True or False. (4)
- (i) Mrs. Mallard suffered from a weak heart.
 - (ii) Richards first confirmed the news of Mr. Mallard's death before informing Josephine.
 - (iii) Mrs. Mallard was heartbroken because she had never loved her husband.
 - (iv) Mrs. Mallard died of disappointment rather than joy.
- (d) Arrange the following sentences in the right order. (2)
- (i) Mrs. Mallard looked out through the open window and saw new life in nature.
 - (ii) Richards brought the news of Brently Mallard's death.
 - (iii) Mrs. Mallard realized she was free to live for herself.
 - (iv) Brently Mallard returned home, alive and unaware of the accident.

- (e) Match the words/terms with their meanings. (3)

S.No.	Words		Meanings
(i)	Afflicted	(1)	A magical or medicinal drink believed to restore life
(ii)	Elixir	(2)	freedom from control or influence
(iii)	Independence	(3)	something that causes physical suffering or pain

- (f) Complete the sentences with the correct option. (2)

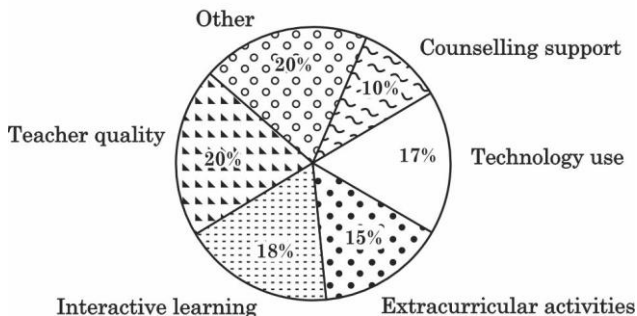
- (i) Mrs. Mallard whispered the word _____ repeatedly as she realized her new sense of freedom.

(free / gone / joy / peace)

- (ii) The doctors concluded that Mrs. Mallard died of _____ (heart disease / grief / hunger / accident)

17. (a) Write a brief report based on the pie chart presented below. (5)

Student Engagement Factors



- (b) Write a bio-sketch of your favourite actor. (10).
18. (a) Analyze the author's narrative technique in blending travelogue with food writing, enhance the reader's experience of Mangalorean food culture in the essay. "On searching for a once-lost love". (15)

Or

- (b) Evaluate the depiction of resilience and self-belief in *The Pursuit of Happiness* in relation to Chris Gardner's professional and personal success. (15)